

Dear McKinsey & Company Hiring Team,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my strong interest in the Junior Associate position at McKinsey & Company. With a strong foundation in life sciences and hands-on experience in both clinical and academic research settings, I am eager to bring my analytical mindset, problem-solving skills, and collaborative spirit to your dynamic team.

I am a 2024 graduate of the Medical Biology master's program with a specialization in Science, Management & Innovation (SMI) from Radboud University. I am passionate about creating sustainable and cutting-edge solutions, which is why I am thrilled to contribute to McKinsey's mission of driving transforming, impactful outcomes to a diverse range of clients.

My academic background equips me with a solid foundation for this role. During the SMI track of my master's, I gained valuable insights into digital healthcare, health technology assessment, market research, value propositions, and health economics. My master's thesis focused on the added value of home telemonitoring technology and gave me experience working with elderly patients and medical professionals. Thus, my specialization honed my skills in stakeholder communication, innovation strategy, and regulatory awareness – competencies essential for a consultant.

In addition to my academic qualifications, my professional experience will be a significant advantage for working at McKinsey & Company. In my previous roles as a Junior Research Assistant and later as a Clinical Research Organization Assistant, I contributed to multidisciplinary projects that required data-driven analysis, stakeholder coordination, and strategic thinking. I was responsible for tasks ranging from data analysis and stakeholder coordination to translating scientific findings into actionable insights. These experiences taught me how to break down complex problems, manage ambiguity, and deliver practical solutions.

What draws me to McKinsey is your culture of collaboration, continuous learning, and real-world impact. The opportunity to grow as a consultant, work with top-tier professionals, and contribute to realistic solutions deeply resonates with both my professional goals and personal values.

I am confident in presenting complex ideas to diverse audiences, from scientific peers to business stakeholders, and I take ownership of my work. I am fluent in English and am actively improving my Dutch fluency. I believe my background and drive would make me a great fit for the Junior Associate role.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be delighted to further discuss how my experience and aspirations align with McKinsey's mission and values. Please feel free to reach out if you have any questions.

Warm regards,
Varvara Lazarenko